

Resume Writing Checklist

GENERAL FORMATTING

- ☐ Font size is 9–11, 10 is the most popular, section headings are one font size larger (except your name, it can be 14–18)
- ☐ Font style is consistent (e.g., Arial, Times New Roman, or Calibri)
- ☐ Resume is 1–2 pages in length (depending on experience)
- ☐ Spacing is consistent throughout
- ☐ No grammar, spelling, or punctuation errors
- ☐ Saved as a PDF (unless otherwise requested)

Header / Contact Information

- ☐ Full Name in **bold**, font size 14–18
- ☐ Address (optional, regular font size)
- ☐ City, Province, Postal Code (if address is included)
- ☐ Mobile phone number
- ☐ Professional email address (e.g., first.last@georgebrown.ca) GBC email as your primary
- ☐ Ensure your email is checked regularly, add a signature in your email

Objective Statement

- ☐ Clearly identifies the **position**, **field**, and **organization**
- ☐ Concise and targeted—avoid vague or generic language
- ☐ Must be tailored/customized to each job you apply to

Highlights of Qualifications

- ☐ 5–7 bullet points tailored to each job description
- ☐ Includes **experience**, **training**, **technical**, and **transferable** skills
- ☐ Each point is **concise** and demonstrates value to the employer, refer to the syntax of a well written bullet

Technical Skills, if you added a technical skill in your highlights you don't need to duplicate it here

- ☐ Lists computer software, tools, or programming languages
- ☐ Demonstrates skills not already covered under Highlights of Qualifications
- ☐ Tailored to the job/industry (e.g., Microsoft Office, Python, SQL, Photoshop)

Education

- ☐ Includes **full program names** and **institutions, locations** (no abbreviations)
- ☐ Listed in **reverse chronological order** (most recent first)
- ☐ Includes **start to completion dates (Jan 2025-Dec 2025)** **right align all dates**
- ☐ Must add relevant **research or class projects** to show practical experience in your current program only

Certifications

- ☐ List certifications relevant to the role in the Education Section call the Section **Education/Certifications**
- ☐ Include **certification name**, **issuing organization**, and **dates**, **right align all dates**

- ☐ If you have certifications not relevant to the role, you can add another **Certifications** section after your Professional Experience

Professional Experience

- ☐ Listed in reverse chronological order (most recent first)
- ☐ Includes **job title, company name, location, and dates, right align all dates**
- ☐ Each role includes 5–7 bullet points of achievements/responsibilities
- ☐ Uses action verbs (e.g., managed, developed, collaborated)
- ☐ Quantify results where possible (e.g., “reduced costs by 20%”)
- ☐ Focus is on **skills and accomplishments**, not just duties

Volunteer Experience (optional)

- ☐ Listed similarly to paid experience (job title, organization, dates)
- ☐ Highlights community involvement, leadership, or transferable skills
- ☐ Bullet points describe specific responsibilities or outcomes

Interests or Hobbies (optional)

- ☐ Includes constructive interests (e.g., sports, reading, music, volunteering)
- ☐ Avoids anything too personal or irrelevant
- ☐ Shows personality and transferable soft skills (e.g., teamwork, discipline)

Additional Notes

☐ **Customize for Each Job**

Tailor your resume to match the job posting. Use the same keywords and highlight the skills and experiences that align best with the role.

Use Action Verbs

- ☐ Start each bullet point with strong action verbs (e.g., *coordinated, developed, improved, analyzed*) to demonstrate impact and initiative.

Quantify Achievements

- ☐ Include measurable results whenever possible (e.g., *increased social media engagement by 30%, managed a team of 5*). **You must be prepared to explain in an interview**

Avoid Personal Pronouns

- ☐ Don't use “I,” “me,” or “my.” Keep the language professional and focused on achievements.

Don't Include Unnecessary Personal Details

- ☐ Don't add age, marital status, SIN number, or a photo

Use Reverse Chronological Order

- ☐ For both education, certifications, professional experience, volunteer experience list the most recent first and work backward.

Proofread Carefully

- ☐ Have someone else review your resume. Even small errors can create a negative impression.

Use Professional File Names

- ☐ Save your resume with a clear and professional filename, e.g.,
Firstname_Lastname_Resume_Company.pdf.

Keep Layout Clean and Consistent

- ☐ Avoid overusing bold, italics, or underlining. Use white space and clear section headings to improve readability.
- ☐ Keep your resume to **one to two pages**, if using two pages fill two pages and add your contact information on both pages